Ran LIU （刘然）

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Education

Columbia Business School (CBS), Columbia University, New York, U.S. 2016–2022, 2025–2026
PhD in Finance
Dissertation: *Essays on Informational Efficiency of the Financial Markets*
Committee: Laura Veldkamp (Advisor), Paolo Siconolfi (Chair), Neng Wang, Jane Li, Simon Oh

Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI), Madrid, Spain 2014–2016
MA in Economics and Finance, with Distinction

University of International Business and Economics (UIBE), Beijing, China 2010–2014
BA in Economics (Major: Financial Engineering), with Honors
BA in Management (Minor: Information Management and Information Systems)

Fields of Interest

Asset pricing, information economics, market microstructure, behavioral finance

Working Papers

1. **Market Access and the Production of Information** (Job Market Paper)
   - Presented at Columbia (2020, 2021, 2022), CIFFP (2026, scheduled)
   - Funded by the Chazen Institute for Global Business and the Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics
   - **Abstract**: Market access changes which assets investors can hold and, in turn, reshapes how they allocate scarce data-processing capacity across assets—including assets they cannot hold. Investors with partial access engage in cross-asset learning only when the auxiliary asset is informative enough to be useful but not so informative that its information is already efficiently revealed through prices. As a result, market access can separate different dimensions of informational efficiency: making an asset investable can reduce its price informativeness, while in other cases prices become more informative even as average posterior precision falls. A China calibration shows that partial market access can generate large equilibrium effects by substantially reshaping information allocation and price informativeness despite a small foreign ownership share. Expanding foreign investability further has little impact, while relaxing the short-sale constraint substantially improves price informativeness.

2. **Reading the Tea Leaves: Benefits and Costs of Learning about Future Demand Shocks** (under review at the *Journal of Economic Theory*; available at `https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7489552`)
   - Presented at the AFA Poster Session (2021), FTG Summer School (2019), and Columbia (2018, 2019)
   - **Abstract**: This paper fills a gap in the noisy rational expectations equilibrium literature by characterizing the equilibrium effects of learning about future demand shocks. A novel future uncertainty channel breaks the fallacy of composition: while investors gain at the individual level from lower conditional variances of future excess payoffs, aggregate acquisition of dividend information still declines, rendering dividends riskier and raising risk premia. Heterogeneity in private information amplifies volatility, and learning about future demand shocks renders prices less informative now but more informative in the future.

3. **From Persistent Disagreement to Agreement: Learning with Revisions of Perception Sets**
   - Presented at Columbia (2021)
   - **Abstract**: This paper examines the learning process, focusing on perception. Agents process identical sensory information through heterogeneous perceptual sets, generating different perceptual signals that

update posterior beliefs. Biased perceptual sets give rise to persistent disagreement, while set revision corrects perceptual biases and leads to agreement. Depending on the intensity of perceptual shocks, agents' sensitivities, and their initial levels of entrenchment, the market overreacts or underreacts to sensory information. Trading volume rises when overreaction occurs.

Publications in Chinese

Taxation Problems Faced by China's Venture Capital Enterprises and the Solutions, with Xuan Zhou and Yanhong Liu, *Public Finance Research* (《财政研究》), 2012(7).

Conferences and Seminars

China International Forum on Finance and Policy (Macau, 2026, scheduled)
CBS PhD Seminar, Free Lunch Seminar and Finance Seminar (Columbia, 2018–2022)
AFA Poster Session (virtual, 2021)
Finance Theory Group Summer School (Wharton, 2019)

Research Assistantships

Laura Veldkamp, CBS	2018–2022
Enrique Sentana and Dante Amengual, CEMFI	2015
Manxue Qu, Dept. of Finance, UIBE	2013–2014
Yi Fang, Development Research Centre of the State Council of China	2013
Xuan Zhou, Dept. of Management, UIBE	2011–2013

Teaching Assistantships

Doctoral

Economic Analysis IV (PhD), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021, SP 2020
Economic Analysis III (PhD), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021
Continuous-Time Finance (PhD), Neng Wang	FA 2020, SP/FA 2019
Computing for Business Research (PhD), Daniel Mechanic	FA 2017

Master's

Corporate Finance (EMBA), Roger Mesznik	FA 2021, FA 2019
Game Theory and Business (MBA), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021, SP/FA 2020, SP/FA 2019, SP/FA 2018
Game Theory and Business (MBA), Andrea Prat	FA 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (EMBA/MSc), Roger Mesznik	SP 2021, SP 2020, SP 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (MSc), John Moon	SU 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (MSc), Neng Wang	SP 2018
Managerial Economics (EMBA), Andrea Prat	FA 2019

Undergraduate

Money and Banking (UG), Manxue Qu	FA 2012

Scholarships, Fellowships, and Honors

CBS Doctoral Fellowship	2016–2022
Fundación ICO (Instituto de Crédito Oficial) Scholarships	2014–2016
Beijing Outstanding Graduate	2014
UIBE Outstanding Bachelor's Thesis	2014
National Scholarship of China	2011, 2013
UIBE Outstanding Student & First-Class Scholarship	2010–2013

China School of Banking and Finance Yangmei First-Class Scholarship 2013

Internships

Analyst, Research Dept., Valuebed Capital Co., Shenzhen (remote from Beijing) 2013
Investment Counselor, China Merchants Securities, Beijing 2012–2013

Other Training

Mongolian Language, Central Eurasian Studies, Indiana University, Bloomington, U.S. 2023–2024
Methods Summer Programme, London School of Economics, London, U.K. 2013

Additional Information

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), Mongolian (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate)
Computer skills: C, Python, Bash, LaTeX, SQL, MATLAB, Mathematica, Stata, R, Java
Year of Birth: 1993
Citizenship: Chinese

Academic References

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Leon G. Cooperman Professor
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Cheung Kong Graduate School of Business
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